One in 10 vendors say their suppliers have already started charging extra for payments made through the Unified Payments Interface (UPI), even though no merchant discount rate (MDR) has yet been levied, according to a survey by the Indian School of Business (ISB). The survey covered 722 vendors across 64 cities and towns in 14 states and UTs between September 24 and October 10. Of these, 10.4 per cent said their suppliers had asked for additional charges on UPI payments in the preceding 10 days. Seven in 10 vendors pay suppliers over ₹2,000 per stock, which is the range the MDR framework covers.

"They (vendors) do not really attribute this to the MDR, but whenever they wanted to pay using UPI, they were asked to pay some additional charge. Vendors were indicating that UPI will have an additional charge whereas when they wish to pay in cash, this charge would not be there," said Mohan Ramanath, co-author of the report. OUR BUREAU

NPCI forms unit for AI, blockchain; names Vishal Kanvaty MD & CEO

The National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) has formed NPCI Tech Solutions Limited (NTSL), a wholly owned subsidiary that will serve as the technology and innovation arm of the NPCI group, and appointed Vishal Kanvaty as its managing director and chief executive officer (MD & CEO), the umbrella body for retail payments said on Wednesday. NTSL will build capabilities in blockchain, digital financial infrastructure and global capability centre (GCC) services. The company will also provide technology services for eKYC Setu, the Unified Ticketing Platform (UTP) and other digital public infrastructure (DPI) programmes, NPCI said. The subsidiary was set up with approval from the NPCI board and the RBI. It is NPCI's fourth wholly owned subsidiary. Kanvaty has been

NTSL will build capabilities outside NPCI's core payments mandate. Its focus areas are artificial intelligence (AI), subsidiary. Kanvaty has been with NPCI for nearly a decade and is currently its chief technology officer. OUR BUREAU



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